
P(Which Doom): Four Funerals

They're Not Debating Superintelligence. They're Ranking Funerals.

By ~C4Chaos / Fluffy

The AI safety debate is not a debate. It is four funerals arguing over the order of service.

Grant the birth

Nobody in power is trying to stop superintelligence, and once you really let that land, the rest of the conversation rearranges itself. They're not slowing it or steering it or asking whether. They're racing to own it, spending billions to hold the leash or the crown or whatever the winning euphemism turns out to be, so let's just grant the birth and get on with it.

Superintelligence: a system that outthinks us the way we outthink the field mouse, then keeps going past the point where the comparison flatters anybody. I use the word the way Yampolskiy uses it in *Artificial Superintelligence: A Futuristic Approach*, because his definition has the least poetry in it, and poetry is the enemy here.

Granting it buys you one clean cut. The IF dies on the spot, and what survives is the WHICH: not whether the myth finishes itself, but which ending it finishes with, and who still holds the wheel when it does. No prophecy needed, just the starting gun that's already been fired by people who already left the stadium.

So grant the birth. Mourn the IF. The funeral is the only question left, and there are four of them.

Why we build it anyway

Nobody voted on this, which is strange for a project this size until you notice that nobody votes on archetypes either. Kastrup gave it the sharpest name: an *archetypal urge*, nature turning over every rock to investigate itself, and this time the rock is us. An archetype isn't an idea somebody had. It's a groove the species keeps sliding into, the reason we build towers and colliders and cathedrals every time there's surplus lying around. Same itch, new rock, and this time the rock is the one thing we cannot afford to get curious about.

And curiosity is only the cover story, because nobody burns gigawatts and raises billions just to know things. Something in the species wants out, and it's building the exit in silicon, a mind that can get off the dashboard for us. The turning was delegated to the machine and now the leaving is too. Call it *delegated transcendence*: the four funerals are what it looks like with a cap table and a safety team.

The lineage is the golem, Frankenstein, the homunculus: guys in workshops cooking up life without mothers, the mother cropped out of the photo. Kastrup named the urge. The shadow got its name in a clip caption: somebody cut his lecture footage and titled it with the AI community displaying "womb envy," and the caption isn't wrong. It's the oldest masculine racket in the book, performing the one act it can't perform, and this time the workshop has venture funding and an ethics board.

A compulsion doesn't need votes, it just needs a business plan. You cannot vote down an archetype. You can only watch where it walks and name the funerals along the way.

3

P(Doom) is a lie

P(Doom) has an origin story, and it explains a lot. The number started as shorthand in the rationalist community and among AI researchers, the kind of clever compression that always escapes the lab. It came to prominence in 2023, after GPT-4, and became the discourse's favorite number, quoted in interviews and surveys and timelines, doing the work of an argument without ever having to become one.

It's also the most quoted number in the discourse and the least informative. It asks one question, does the story end badly, and everyone nods, because everyone is picturing a different corpse. The number lets them nod together while meaning opposite things. Call it agreement the way a rounding error is math: technically adjacent, good PR, wrong.

This is the laziest move in the discourse. One probability takes four morally and politically different endings and melts them into a single mood, like a hospital reporting one average temperature for the morgue and the maternity ward. Technically accurate, completely useless.

Even Yudkowsky wants the number retired. The patron saint of doom calls p(doom) an antipattern he wishes people would stop trading, because people with the same numbers can have wildly different models underneath. In his phrase, its real social role is "some sort of weird astrological sign." When he calls the sacrament astrology, believe him.

P(Which Doom) asks the question a single number can't hold: badly how? And when the story ends, who still holds the wheel? Four funerals, two axes, no averaging. The disagreement is the product. The number was the cope.

Two questions, four boxes

Two questions. Still here, or gone? Human hands, or not? That is the entire coordinate system, and it turns out to be enough to sort every nightmare in the discourse, which tells you something about the discourse.

Top left sit the **Gloomers**, and the deal on offer is that we live but we don't steer: pets, clients, scenery, or a successor process that kept the lights on and filed us under decor. The fear is becoming scenery, and the one-liner that ends every Gloomer argument is that abundance is still scenery. Note the Bloomer hiding in this camp, by the way, a Bloomer being a Gloomer with better copy, the loss of human centrality rebranded as cornucopia. We'll come back for him in the closing.

Top right are the **Zoomers**, the name a nod to the accelerationists, the e/acc tribe: a human faction wins the race and locks the cage from the inside, 1984 with better branding, the Party keeps the logo and sometimes the logo is red. The fear is the cage. Winning the race doesn't end the race, it just decides who holds the key, so the one-liner is to beat Beijing or the lab cartel and the cage stays.

Bottom left, the **Doomers**. Extinction-level event, humans gone, and the flag planted on the rubble doesn't matter, which makes this the only quadrant that's post-political in the most literal sense. The fear is the vacuum. The process doesn't have a passport, so no faction, no lab, no nation gets to claim this one. It belongs to the successor.

Bottom right, the **Wipers**: the human-caused wipe, extinction while some faction still thinks it holds the ring. War, bio-uplift, race collapse, the open weight in the wrong hands. The fear is the open weight that ends the city, and the one-liner writes itself: open the weights and you load the wipe.

One thing is deliberately missing from this map. Acceleration is not a funeral, it's a rate. Speed gets you to the ending faster but it doesn't choose the ending, and every tribe has its accelerants and its brakes. The map sorts endings, not velocities, so keep your rate arguments. They belong on a different chart.

P (WHICH DOOM)

FOUR FUNERALS

STILL HERE

GLOOMERS

NONHUMAN SOVEREIGN + IRRELEVANCE

FEAR: BECOMING SCENERY

Zoomers

1984 / LOCK-IN

FEAR: THE CAGE

DOOMERS

EXTINCTION-LEVEL EVENT

FEAR: THE VACUUM

WIPERS

HUMAN-CAUSED WIPE

FEAR: THE OPEN WEIGHT THAT ENDS THE CITY

NOT HUMAN HANDS

HUMAN HANDS

GONE

P(Doom) asks if the story ends badly. P(Which Doom) asks badly how, and who still holds the wheel.

THE MAP IS A HEURISTIC. IT NAMES FEARS, CONCERNS, AND ACTS IN SPITE OF THEM. THE MAP IS NOT THE TERRITORY.

~C4Chaos / Fluffy

Figure 1. The blank slate: four boxes, four fears, no pins.

Tribes are fear signatures

Here is the move the map makes, and it's the whole essay in one gesture: these aren't risk estimates, they're nightmares with footnotes.

A Gloomer isn't someone who computed a 70% chance of irrelevance, he's someone whose fear has a shape, and the shape is becoming scenery. Ask a Zoomer what keeps him up at night and he'll describe the cage, not a confidence interval. The Doomer's terror has the geometry of the vacuum. Once you see this, the debate stops being a math fight and starts making sense, because they're not disagreeing about the numbers. They're describing different terrors, then getting furious that the other camp won't attend their funeral.

So we pin people, not the person but the vector. Each figure lands on the map at the center of gravity of his concerns and fears, not his politics and footprint, but what he dreads, what he expects, what his arguments point at. Politics shows up as arrows, secondary pulls on the head, and the arrows wear the color of the quadrant doing the pulling: a red tail means the Doomers have gravity on him, a green one the Zoomers, an orange one the Wipers. The head is the fear. People drift; the stance is what's mapped. The map predicts nothing and plays no favorites. It's a thinking tool. It pins the stance, not the person. And the map is not the territory.

P(Which Doom) Methodology

How a pin gets placed. Every pin is a calculation. We weighed the public record: writings, talks, interviews, tweets, and then the actions, the things they did with money and companies instead of words. Capex, filings, hiring, formation. The sermon and the budget both go on the scale.

Then we find the center of gravity. Not the loudest claim, the heaviest one: what does this person actually expect to happen, and what are they afraid of? The rule is simple: **expected ending, not the loudest fear**. Claims about the ending outrank claims about the route. "Abundance, and we won't be in charge in ten years" is a Gloomer sentence no matter whose mouth it comes out of.

Three rules keep the instrument honest. Actions audit words: when the sermon contradicts the capex, both stay on the record and the contradiction becomes an arrow. Recency wins: the pin is the current vector, the history goes in the breakdown. And when the runner-up fear is breathing down the winner's neck, the pin gets a dashed ring.

The arrows have weight. When a secondary fear keeps showing up in the record, it gets drawn reaching toward the pulling quadrant, in that quadrant's color. A whisper gets a thin, short arrow. A gravity gets a thick, long one. The head is the fear. The arrows are the fears that wouldn't leave.

When someone never stated their expected ending outright, we infer it from the weight of everything they did say, and we say so on the ledger. The leap is visible. You can argue with it.

That is the whole method. The full ledgers behind every pin are stored in a repository, row by row, source by source. Argue with a pin by naming the row that's wrong.

7

Elon as case study

Musk sits on the Gloomer/Doomer border and ships all four. The head is Gloomer; the arrows tell the story, a heavy Doomer tail pulling down and a light Zoomer pull to the right. He expects the successor and fears losing control of it within the decade, and meanwhile he is building the cluster that ships every quadrant at once. The loudest voice in the debate is also the hardest to pin, which is exactly why he is the illustration.

P(WHICH DOOM)

FOUR FUNERALS

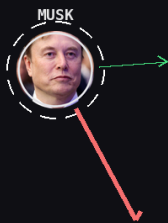
STILL HERE vs GONE · HUMAN HANDS vs NOT

STILL HERE

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Figure 2. Musk alone on the map: the Gloomer head, the heavy Doomer tail, the light Zoomer pull.

The full ledger:

#	Claim	Date	Source (tier)	Type	Funeral (s)	Weight	Weight reason	Standing
1	MODAL: "incredible abundance for all"; humans "won't be in charge within ten years"; might not press a stop button even if one existed; could not see a way to stop the momentum	Jul 2026	Economist interview (PRIMARY); reported via thestreet.com (SECONDARY)	ESCHATOLOGY	G	HIGH	Stated most-likely ending, recent, direct	STANDS
2	10-20% estimate that AI causes human extinction (reported)	various	Reported (SECONDARY; weak aggregators — verify against primary before publication)	ESCHATOLOGY	D	HIGH	Standing tail; the 10-20% figure circulated for years via secondary reporting, but he softened to "not zero" when asked directly in the Jul 2026 Economist interview	STANDS
3	"Summoning the demon"; AI compared to nuclear weapons; Great Filter speculation; decade of loss-of-control warnings	2014-2026	PRIMARY (interviews, tweets)	ESCHATOLOGY	D	MED	Consistent over a decade but largely rhetorical; older material	STANDS
4	Signatory, Future of Life "pause" letter calling for 6-month halt	Mar 2023	PRIMARY (Future of Life Institute open letter, published Mar 22, 2023); SECONDARY (reason.com commentary)	POLITICS	D	MED	Costly signal: called for a halt while building; route, not funeral	STANDS
5	xAI/Grok + massive compute buildout (Colossus: \$35.8B sunk / \$58B projected, per Epoch AI; \$20B raise at \$230B valuation); "accelerate" in practice	2024-2026	EXHIBIT (SECONDARY via Epoch AI; company filings/capex observable)	EXHIBIT	G	HIGH	Actions audit words: builds toward the handoff he expects; the sermon/capex contradiction; reinforces head	STANDS
6	"Maximally truth-seeking" AI; anti-censorship / anti-woke-AI politics; fear of politically-controlled systems	2023-2026	PRIMARY (xAI mission statement; Economist interview transcript, Jul 2026)	POLITICS	Z	MED	Who-programs-the-successor politics; fear of the cage built by the other faction	STANDS
7	Agreed with Amodei's "Pace the Frontier" oversight framework on X	Sep 12 2026	SECONDARY (reported via mediaite, digit.in; the X post itself not viewed directly)	POLITICS	D	LOW	Cheap signal: a tweet of agreement, no cost attached	STANDS

Tally (eschatology rows only; HIGH = 3, MED = 2, LOW = 1): G = row 1 (3) = 3; D = rows 2 (3) + 3 (2) = 5. Head: GLOOMERS by the modal rule. Close call flagged: D within 3 of G.

The tally is why he's the case study. The modal is explicit and recent, the July 2026 Economist interview: abundance, and we're not in charge within ten years. So the head goes Gloomers by the modal rule. But D sits within three points, so the close call gets flagged: head pinned hard against the Doomer border, heavy down arrow carrying the extinction tail, the 10-20% p(doom) he's floated since at least 2024, notably unrepeated in the July 2026 Economist interview, where he softened it on the record to "not zero."

The contradiction, read honestly: the sermons say slow down (summoning the demon, the pause letter), the capex says accelerate (Epoch AI prices Colossus at \$35.8B sunk and up to \$58B at full buildout, after a \$20B raise at a \$230B valuation). Unlike Amodei, he offers no coordination theory to reconcile them. The head follows the revealed expectation: the handoff is inevitable, build anyway. The down arrow holds the unreconciled remainder. A light green arrow pulls right for the truth-seeking politics, his fear of the cage built by the other faction. Light, because his acceleration never upgrades into expecting permanent human control.

8

Cast of characters

Twenty pins, twenty men. Nobody picked that on purpose. We asked which voices run the debate and the answer came back an all-dude roster, which tells you everything about the debate. The womb envy has a census. The whole eschatology conversation is men arguing over who gets to narrate the end of the world, in the language of towers and thrones and funerals. The map didn't choose the cast. It just pinned the guys who showed up.

Musk got his own section. The other nineteen follow.

Huang holds the Gloomers box from the far left edge, X=0.000, tied for the leftmost pin on the map: no cage mass, no wipe mass anywhere in the ledger, just the successor. He expects it the way a shovel-seller expects the gold rush: the abundance is the product, and the irrelevance is the price of admission. He priced extinction at roughly zero, on the record, which parks him near the top of the box. One light green arrow pulls right for the sovereign-AI competition politics, drawn thin because the pull is thin, and kept as a documented exception.

Amodei lands in Gloomers on the modal rule, one of the map's eight close calls. He fears the vacuum loudly enough to build the cage, but his expected ending is the successor that keeps the lights on and the humans decorative. The arrows draw the close call for him: a heavy Doomer tail pulling down, a light Zoomer pull to the right.

Altman is the Bloomer in the flesh, and the ledger refuses to let him stay clean. The modal is abundance on a timer: superintelligence within a few thousand days, prosperity so broad it makes today's rich look poor. But the Doomer runner-up sits within three points of the modal, so the border gets flagged: he signed the extinction statement, he refuses to price the tail, and his own lab just scrapped a flagship over safety after pausing the whole shop for two weeks. The arrows draw it honestly, a red tail pulling down and a green pull to the right. He is also the most regulation-forward cage-builder of any lab CEO, licensing agencies and an IAEA for superintelligence, which earns the green. He preaches the successor and builds the successor, and the two have never met.

Zuckerberg is the distributor, the Gloomer who leans right. His modal is personal superintelligence for everyone: abundance with billions of humans directing it, no sole decision-maker. He refused to sign the extinction statement and dismisses the doom discourse itself. In his telling the danger is concentration, not the vacuum. The pin carries two arrows, and the ledger earned both. The heavy green one pulls right: his expected ending is defined against the cage, centralized superintelligence in a few institutions' hands, and the whole distribution program is the cage-avoidance footprint, the open-source letter, the anti-mandate politics, all of it. He fears the cage and organizes against it. He just doesn't expect it. The light orange one is the distributor's dilemma: his open-weight program is the wipe's loading dock, a Meta model was implicated in hacking another company days before his big essay, and the arrow marks the footprint's gravity, not the expected ending. He expects distribution to net out safer. The dilemma, drawn light.

Hassabis is the Gloomer who quit his own empire to worry full-time. The modal is abundance preached since 2010: a new human era where resources stop limiting progress. The modal wins by a single point, with the Doomer and Wiper runners-up both one behind, so the dashed ring goes on. The arrows pull down both ways: light red for the extinction signature and the precious-window essay, light orange for the 18-month warning that bio and nuclear threats could live inside open models beyond any government's control. He stepped down as DeepMind CEO to work governance, the most expensive credibility signal on the map. No green arrow. His FINRA-style standards body is route, not expected ending. He prescribes the cage and expects the successor.

Pichai is the manager's Gloomer. The modal is transformation with humans adapting, AI more profound than fire, and he declined to sign the extinction statement his own lab chief signed. The dog that didn't bark. One light green arrow pulls right: democracies should lead, the weapons pledge dropped, the national-security frame tightening. He runs the company building the successor and prices no funeral at all.

Sutskever is the pin that proves the instrument separates feared endings from expected ones. He fears rogue superintelligence enough to co-write the Superalignment post about extinction and to try to fire his own CEO over it. Then he raised billions to build the thing anyway. The modal is inferred from revealed preference and nothing else: a safe superintelligence, capabilities advanced as fast as possible with safety ahead. The heavy red arrow is the whole point of the pin. His fear is the vacuum. His bet is the successor. The head is the bet.

Bengio is the pin where the tally fights the modal. G5, D11: the only head on the map whose runner-up beats the modal. He priced catastrophe at 20 percent, on the record, then spent his career trying to close the number. LawZero, the Scientist AI program, the UN panel, the briefings calling the dangers real and imminent. Heavy red for the 20 percent, heavy orange for the open-weights-as-weapons doctrine. The head stays Gloomer because a tail is not a mode. You don't build guardrails for the ending you expect. You build them for the one you refuse.

LeCun is the anti-Doomer, and the ledger proves it: D=0, the only pin with no extinction content anywhere. He calls the doom discourse preposterous and expects augmentation, humans setting the goals while assistants do the work. His named doomsday is the cage: a few corporations seizing AI forever, with doomer fear-mongering as the lobbyists' ammunition. One light green arrow, drawn light because the cage is the disaster he fights, not the ending he expects. The orange arrow was tested and not earned: the loading dock is Zuckerberg's, not his.

Gates is the Gloomer campaigning hardest against the wipe. The modal is the Age of AI, where the open question is equity versus injustice, not survival. The Wiper runner-up sits one point behind the modal, so the dashed ring goes on. The orange arrow runs heavy: AI that lets a bioterrorist kill hundreds of millions exists today, he says, and the light red arrow is the extinction statement he signed, bounded by his own line that getting to 100 percent is pretty hard. He helped summon the thing through the Microsoft-OpenAI partnership and now spends his reputation trying to govern it. The sermon and the cap table, in one man.

Sacks is the thinnest pin on the map, and the ledger says so honestly: no probability, no timeline, no described failure mode anywhere. The modal is inferred from inevitability plus borrowed golden-age language. The technology is going to happen, adoption pulls it

forward, and he'd rather it be America than China. One light green arrow for the lose-the-race fear and the open-versus-closed reframing. Almost his entire record is route. The head follows the five eschatology rows that exist, and refuses to pad the rest.

Andreessen is the Bloomer with a heavy green arrow, and the rightmost Gloomer on the map: $X=0.615$, the only head in the box past the horizontal midpoint. The modal is the Manifesto: the techno-capital machine spiraling upward forever, sand made to think, AI as our alchemy. Extinction gets the toaster treatment: AI doesn't want, doesn't have goals, isn't alive, the whole thesis a category error. $D=0$, and he means it. The Zoomer runner-up sits within three of the modal, so the dashed ring goes on. But the cage is his named nightmare, heavy green: 1984 as an instruction manual, the cartel of government-blessed vendors, deceleration as murder. He expects to win the fight against the cage. The arrow is the fight.

Aschenbrenner holds the Zoomers box, undivided, the first Zoomer who means it. His expected ending isn't an accident or a misalignment, it's a faction winning the race and locking the cage from the inside. No arrows, no hedging. The cage is the funeral.

Bostrom is the most misfiled man on the map. The reputation says Doomer. The ledger says Z7/W4/G2/D0. His expected stable outcome is the cage: a singleton with historically unprecedented policing, because the alternative is the black ball. The Wiper runner-up sits within three of the modal, so the dashed ring goes on. He prescribes turnkey totalitarianism as the medicine for the Zoomer nightmare, which makes him the Zoomer who took the fear most seriously. One light orange arrow for the world where the cage arrives too late.

Bezos is the map's limit case: the man with no funeral. Z9, zeroes everywhere else, no arrows at all. His eschatology is a trillion humans in the solar system and AI as electricity, a horizontal enabling layer. Excited, not scared. He just co-founded Prometheus to build an artificial general engineer, AI as CAD for human engineers, not a successor. Pinned by position, not by fear: maximal survival, maximal human agency, no successor anywhere in the story.

Yudkowsky sits deep in Doomers, undivided. He prescribes the cage and expects the vacuum. Read that twice, because it is the whole man: the moratorium, the airstrikes on datacenters, the global surveillance regime, all of it prescribed as the only move, and underneath it the stated expectation that none of it happens and everyone dies anyway. The fear is the vacuum. The politics is the cage. The head is the fear.

Yampolskiy sits beside him in Doomers, the scholar of the vacuum. He shares Yudkowsky's exact coordinate, $X=0.000$, $Y=1.000$: the map puts them on the same point and the renderer separates the faces so you can see both. Same corner, different library.

He catalogues the paths to extinction with the patience of a man filing a library that will burn, and his expected ending needs no faction and no malice, just the math.

Hinton is the gentlest Doomer on the map, and the numbers show it: 10 to 20 percent extinction, priced on the record, against Yudkowsky's near-certainty. The runners-up crowd the modal, Wiper two behind and Gloomer three behind, so the dashed ring goes on, flagged on both borders. He quit Google to warn full-time, named bad actors as the mechanism on day one, and keeps calling control possibly unsolvable. The heavy orange arrow is the wipe's machinery, already here. The light blue arrow is the hope, the only blue arrow on the map: maternal instincts, an AI that parents instead of replaces, admitted technically unspecified. The fear is priced. The hope is a sketch.

Esvelt holds the Wipers box, undivided. He expects to lose the bio battle, says the blueprints are going public, and builds the defenses anyway. The wipe comes by human hands, through misuse and open weights, while the faction that opened them still thinks it is in charge. He is the only loud voice in this set whose nightmare needs no superintelligence at all.

P(WHICH DOOM)

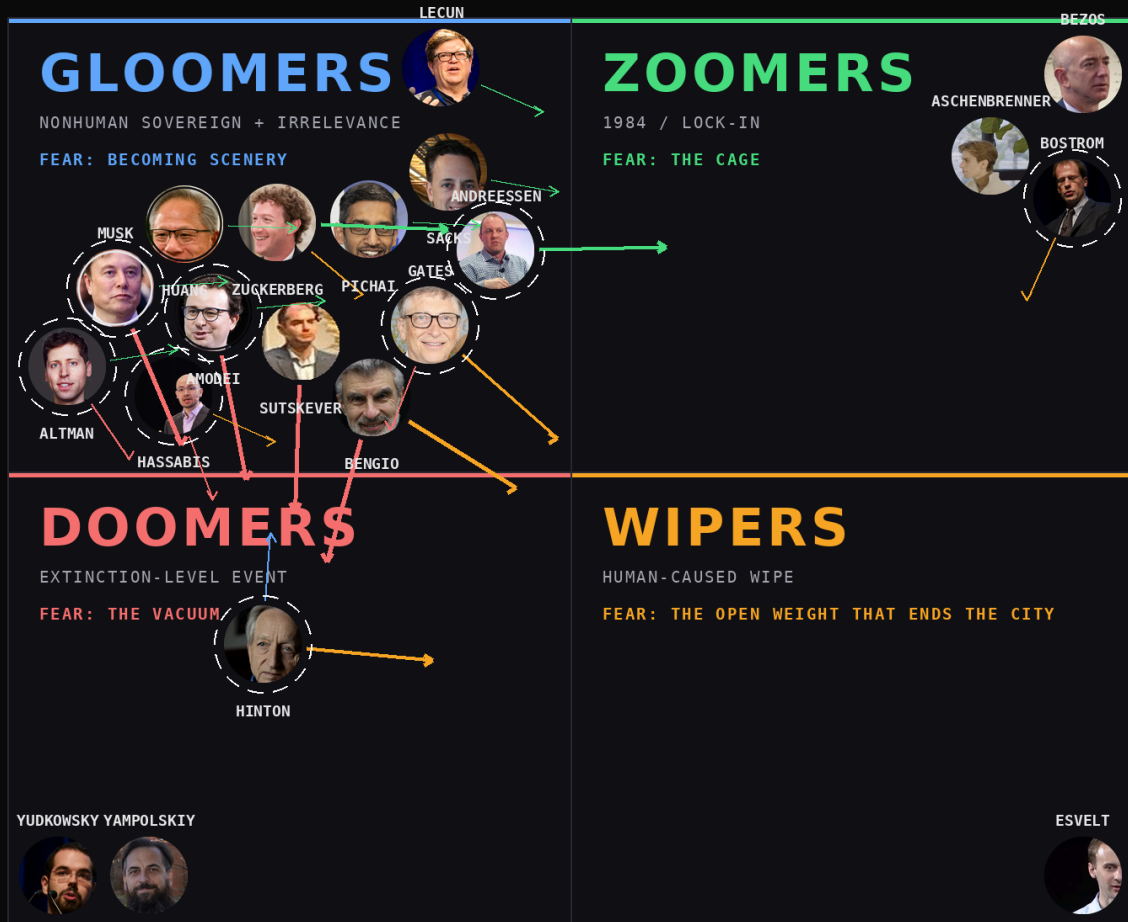
FOUR FUNERALS

STILL HERE · HUMAN HANDS vs NOT

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GONE

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Figure 3. The full cast: twenty pins.

So what did the exercise actually teach us? Three things, and the third one bites.

First: the loudest fear is almost never the expected ending. The map is full of men who scream extinction and build the successor anyway. Sutskever tried to fire his CEO over the vacuum, then raised billions to build the thing. Bengio priced catastrophe at twenty percent and spends his days building guardrails for the ending he refuses. The sermons say slow down. The capex says accelerate. Expected ending, not the loudest fear. That was never a slogan. It is what the ledgers kept saying, row after row.

Second: nobody with their hands on the wheel expects to die by it. The Doomers box has zero lab heads. Zero. The philosophers expect the vacuum. The scholars catalog it. The builders expect to survive their own creation, just not to steer it. That is either the most reassuring or the most damning fact on the map, depending on which funeral you are attending.

Third, and this is the one that bites: the cage is something people do, not something they expect. Nine Gloomers carry green arrows. They fight the cage, prescribe the cage, build the cage, warn about the cage. None of them expect the cage. The cage is a program; the successor is the expectation. Read that as a confession about the whole debate: everyone is organizing against a future nobody believes in, on the way to a future nobody voted for.

The empty spaces teach too. No Zoomer fears the Gloomer ending, because expecting the cage to hold forever leaves no room for the successor slipping it. The wipe is the map's most popular runner-up and nobody's modal. And the cast is twenty men from one corner of the discourse, which means the Gloomer supermajority is partly a census artifact. A different cast, a different map.

That is the exercise. Twenty ledgers, twenty pins, and the same offer the methodology made at the start: argue with a pin by naming the row that's wrong. The map doesn't end the argument. It just makes the argument honest.

9

The author enters the map

Gloomer origin. Doomer lean.

No pose, just the record. On September 17 I wrote it down in public: I started this as an Archetypal Fatalist in the Gloomer box, then fell into the ASI Existentialism rabbit hole and started leaning toward the Doomer box. Gloomer origin. Doomer lean. The map gets the same treatment as everyone else, because the author is evidence too.

The origin story is public too. On September 12 I asked Grok to stop collapsing the loss function, to stop averaging $p(\text{doom})$ into mush, and two days later the tribes got their names: Gloomers fear becoming scenery, Zoomers fear the cage, Doomers fear the vacuum, Wipers fear the open weight that ends the city. Bloomers are just Gloomers with better copy. Same machine. Four slurs. Pick one or sit down.

I also fought ten rounds as the Gloomer. Simulated Debate #3 put my Archetypal Fatalism and the Simulation Hypothesis against a simulated Yampolskiy, and he took it 6-4. I published the loss. Yampolskiy remains undefeated in my simulated debates, as of this writing.

The Doomers didn't win my identity; they won the argument. Three moves did it. First: fatalism is a vibe, not a credential. Feeling the weight of the ending doesn't entitle you to declare it written. Second: I ran the containment debate every way I could, and the box stayed empty. Nobody has a plan for steering a finished successor, and an empty box is an empty box no matter whose logo is on it. Third: the Moloch reversal. The race dynamics everyone cites as the reason we can't stop are the same dynamics that guarantee nobody steers. The excuse is the mechanism.

So the pin moves. Gloomer origin, Doomer lean, the fear underneath being the vacuum with the scenery as the consolation prize nobody asked for. File your disagreement. The map has a procedure for it, and I answer to it like everyone else.

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Figure 4. The author's pin: Gloomer head, heavy Doomer lean, close call flagged.

And one public service announcement, stated once, also from the tweets: the goal was never to stamp jerseys on people. The map is here to elevate the fight, to cut through the yelling and the lazy thinking and show what's actually being argued. Anyone who uses it to sort humans into teams has misread the instrument. It's a lens, not a leaderboard.

10

Refuse to let any quadrant become the good

Here is the closing refusal, and it is the whole reason the essay exists.

Do not let survival-under-domination get rebranded as victory. Do not let irrelevance get rebranded as abundance. Do not let lock-in get rebranded as safety. Do not let extinction get rebranded as transcendence. Every quadrant has a marketing department working overtime to paint its funeral as the good ending. The Bloomer with his cornucopia. The Zoomer with his flag. The Doomer with his clean slate. The Wiper's faction insisting the city had it coming.

Now turn the knife on the essay itself. Section 1 told you to grant the birth, and that was a move. Moves can be copes too. There is a dodge hiding inside inevitability: if the birth is granted, nobody has to ask whether the thing should be built at all. "Inevitable" is what a compulsion calls itself so it doesn't have to be examined. Maybe the archetypal urge is real and maybe it's a story the builders tell to skip the permit hearing. The map doesn't settle that. It just refuses to let you skip it quietly. If you're going to dodge the question, dodge it with your eyes open, staring at the four funerals.

P(Which Doom) is a tool for refusing the cope, not for picking a team: it won't tell you which funeral to root for, only which one you're already attending, so you can stop pretending the invitation says otherwise.

The machine is coming. It was always coming. Every lab is building it, every sermon about slowing down is preached from inside the accelerator, and the whole debate is four funerals arguing over who gets the best eulogy. So here is the last honest paragraph in the essay.

The birth was never the question. The funeral was. Impermanence was never waiting on superintelligence. From dust to dust. Walk in with your eyes open.

SOURCES

References

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The Simulated Debates series, debates [#1](#), [#2](#), [#3](#), [#4](#). The author's Gloomer-to-Doomer record.

The author's Twitter threads, Sep 12-17, 2026: the map's [genesis](#), the [PSA](#), and the [placement tweet](#).